

Using JavaScript

JavaScript is great for creating mini programs that run inside HTML, bringing websites to life and allowing users to interact with them. Although it works like Python, JavaScript code is more concise and trickier to learn.

SEE ALSO

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◀ **122–123** Loops in Python

◀ **208–209** Programming for the Internet

Getting input

As with Python, you can use JavaScript to ask the user for information. JavaScript can do this with a pop-up box. The following program prompts the user to enter their name and responds with a greeting.

1 Use a prompt

This short script stores the user's name in a variable. Type the code into the IDLE code window and remember to save it with a ".html" filename.

```
<script>
var name = prompt("Please enter your name");
var greeting = "Hello " + name + "!";
document.write(greeting);
</script>
```

This line creates a pop-up box and stores the text the user types into it

The text in quotes appears in the box

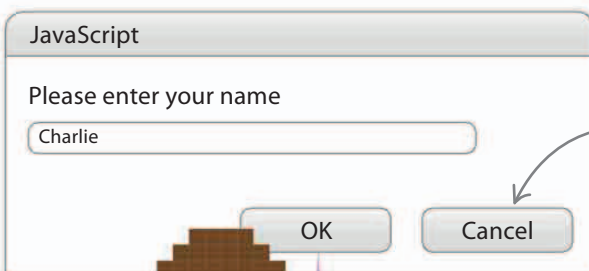
JavaScript lines always end with a semicolon

The "</script>" tag shows where the JavaScript ends

This line displays the greeting

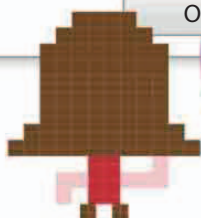
2 Question appears

Double-click the HTML file to launch a browser window. Enter your name in the box and click "OK" to see the greeting.



A prompt box always has "OK" and "Cancel" buttons

The greeting appears in the browser window



EXPERT TIPS

Type carefully

When working with JavaScript, be careful to check that you've typed out the code correctly. If there's an error, the browser will simply ignore the whole block of JavaScript and will create a blank window, without any error message saying what went wrong. If that happens, check the code again carefully.

